

CHEAT SHEET

BASIC LINUX COMMANDS	BASIC GIT COMMANDS
Command • Example • Purpose	Command • Example • Purpose • Flags
pwd — pwd Print current directory.	git init — git init Create/start a Git repository. Flags: -q
ls — ls -la List files; -l details, -a hidden files.	git clone — git clone URL Copy a remote repository. Flags: --depth 1
cd — cd Documents Move to a folder; cd .. goes up.	git status — git status Check files and staged changes. Flags: -s, -b
mkdir — mkdir project Make a new directory.	git add — git add file.txt Stage changes for a commit. Flags: -A, .
rmdir — rmdir old Remove an empty directory.	git restore — git restore file.txt Discard unstaged file changes. Flags: --staged
touch — touch file.txt Create an empty file.	git branch — git branch feature List or create branches. Flags: -a, -d
cp — cp a.txt b.txt Copy a file.	git switch — git switch feature Switch to another branch. Flags: -c
mv — mv old.txt new.txt Move or rename.	git checkout — git checkout feature Older command for switching/restoring. Flags: -b
rm — rm file.txt Delete a file; -r for folders.	git commit — git commit -m "Update" Save staged changes. Flags: -m, -a
cat — cat file.txt Show file contents.	git merge — git merge feature Combine a branch into current branch. Flags: --no-ff
head — head -n 5 file.txt Show first lines.	git log — git log --oneline View commit history. Flags: --oneline, --graph
tail — tail -n 5 file.txt Show last lines.	git tag — git tag v1.0 Give a commit a version label. Flags: -a, -d
grep — grep "word" file.txt Search for text.	git diff — git diff Show unstaged differences. Flags: --staged
find — find . -name "*.html" Find files by name.	git remote — git remote -v Show remote names and URLs. Flags: -v
echo — echo "Hello" Print text.	git fetch — git fetch origin Download remote updates only. Flags: --all
clear — clear Clear terminal screen.	git pull — git pull origin main Fetch and integrate remote changes. Flags: --rebase
chmod — chmod +x script.sh Change file permission.	git push — git push origin main Upload commits to remote. Flags: -u
man — man ls Open a command manual.	git show — git show HEAD Show details of a commit. Flags: --stat
whoami — whoami Show current user.	git reset — git reset HEAD~1 Move HEAD / undo or unstage. Flags: --soft, --hard
history — history Show previous commands.	git revert — git revert HEAD Reverse a commit with a new commit. Flags: --no-edit
	git rm — git rm old.txt Remove a tracked file and stage it. Flags: -r
	git mv — git mv a.txt b.txt Rename/move a tracked file.
	git stash — git stash Temporarily save uncommitted changes. Flags: -u
	git config — git config --global user.name "Name" Set Git settings. Flags: --global
	git clean — git clean -n Preview removal of untracked files. Flags: -f, -n

3. THE THREE-TREE ARCHITECTURE OF GIT

WORKING DIRECTORY	STAGING AREA / INDEX	REPOSITORY
Where the actual files are being edited. Changes here are not yet staged.	A selected snapshot of changes for the next commit. git add moves changes here.	Git's stored commit history. HEAD normally points to the current branch/commit.
Working Directory	→ git add → Staging Area	→ git commit → Repository

